10 Full-text searches

This chapter covers

- Overview of full-text queries
- Working through match queries
- Looking at match phrases, multi-match, and other queries
- Looking at query strings and simple query string queries

In the last chapter, we looked at term-level searching, the mechanism we use to search structured data. Although a structured data search is important, the power of modern search engines vests efficiently and effectively to run when we search unstructured data. Elasticsearch is one such modern search engine that stands as a front-runner in searching unstructured data with relevance.

Elasticsearch provides the capability to search unstructured data through full-text search queries. A full-text search is all about relevancy: fetching the relevant documents to the user's search. For example, when searching for the word *Java* in an online bookstore, one shouldn't expect to receive details about the Indonesian island of Java or the wet-pressed coffee grown on this island.